

Nexora Technologies Pvt. Ltd. - Employee Leave Policy

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Policy Owner: Human Resources Department

Applies To: All full-time employees in India (Chennai, Bengaluru and Coimbatore offices)

This is a fictional policy created for training and demonstration purposes only. Nexora Technologies is not a real company.

1. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to explain the different types of leave available to employees of Nexora Technologies, how leave is earned, how to apply for it, and how unused leave is treated at the end of the year. Nexora believes that rest and personal time are essential for wellbeing and productivity, and encourages every employee to plan and use their leave during the year.

2. Scope and Eligibility

This policy applies to all permanent full-time employees. Interns, consultants and contract staff are covered by separate agreements and should refer to their contract or contact their HR Business Partner.

Employees on probation (the first six months of employment) are eligible for Casual Leave and Sick Leave from the date of joining. Earned Leave starts accruing from the date of joining but can only be used after the probation period is successfully completed, except in emergencies approved by the HR Head.

The leave year runs from **1 January to 31 December**.

3. Summary of Leave Entitlements

Leave Type	Days per Year	Accrual	Carry Forward	Encashable
Casual Leave (CL)	12	Credited 1 per month	No	No
Sick Leave (SL)	12	Credited at start of year	Up to 24 days total	No
Earned Leave (EL)	18	1.5 per month	Up to 30 days	Yes, up to 15 days
Maternity Leave	26 weeks	On eligibility	Not applicable	No
Paternity Leave	10 working days	On eligibility	Not applicable	No
Bereavement Leave	5 working days	Per occurrence	Not applicable	No
Marriage Leave	5 working days	Once during employment	Not applicable	No
Compensatory Off	As earned	Per extra day worked	Must be used within 60 days	No
Public Holidays	10	Fixed calendar	Not applicable	No
Floating Holidays	2	Credited at start of year	No	No

4. Casual Leave (CL)

Casual Leave is meant for short, unplanned personal needs such as attending to family matters, personal errands or urgent travel.

- Every employee receives **12 days of Casual Leave per year**, credited at the rate of one day per month.
- Casual Leave can be taken for a minimum of **half a day** and a maximum of **3 consecutive days** at a time.
- Casual Leave cannot be combined with Earned Leave in the same continuous absence.
- Unused Casual Leave **lapses on 31 December** and is not carried forward or encashed.
- Employees joining mid-year receive Casual Leave on a pro-rata basis. For example, an employee joining on 1 July receives 6 days of Casual Leave for that year.

Casual Leave should ideally be applied for at least one working day in advance. In genuine emergencies it may be applied for on the same day, provided the reporting manager is informed before 10:00 AM.

5. Sick Leave (SL)

Sick Leave is provided so that employees can recover from illness or injury, or attend medical appointments, without loss of pay.

- Employees receive **12 days of Sick Leave per year**, credited in full on 1 January.
- Unused Sick Leave can be carried forward, but the total Sick Leave balance cannot exceed **24 days** at any time.
- Sick Leave of **more than 2 consecutive days** requires a medical certificate from a registered medical practitioner, uploaded to the HR portal within 3 working days of returning to work.
- Sick Leave may also be used to care for an immediate family member (spouse, child or parent) who is unwell, for up to 5 days in a year.
- Sick Leave is not encashable at any time, including at the time of resignation.

If an employee's Sick Leave balance is exhausted, further absence due to illness will be adjusted against Earned Leave, and then treated as Loss of Pay.

6. Earned Leave (EL)

Earned Leave, also called Privilege Leave, is intended for planned vacations, longer personal breaks and family events.

6.1 Accrual

- Employees earn **1.5 days of Earned Leave for every completed month** of service, totalling **18 days per year**.
- Earned Leave is credited on the last working day of each month.
- Leave does not accrue during periods of Loss of Pay longer than 15 days in a month.

6.2 Applying for Earned Leave

- Earned Leave of up to 5 days must be applied for at least **7 calendar days in advance**.
- Earned Leave of more than 5 days must be applied for at least **21 calendar days in advance**.
- A maximum of **15 consecutive days** of Earned Leave may be taken at one time. Longer leave requires approval from the Department Head and HR.
- Weekends and public holidays falling between Earned Leave days are **not counted** as leave.

6.3 Carry Forward and Encashment

- At the end of the leave year, up to **30 days** of unused Earned Leave can be carried forward. Any balance above 30 days lapses.
- Employees may choose to encash up to **15 days** of Earned Leave once per year, in the December payroll. Encashment is calculated on **basic salary only**, using the formula: (Monthly Basic / 30) x Number of days encashed.
- At the time of resignation, the entire Earned Leave balance (up to 30 days) is encashed in the full and final settlement.

7. Maternity Leave

Nexora supports employees during pregnancy and the early months of parenthood, in line with the Maternity Benefit Act, 1961 (as amended).

- Women employees who have worked with Nexora for at least **80 days in the 12 months** before the expected date of delivery are eligible.
- Eligible employees are entitled to **26 weeks of fully paid Maternity Leave** for the first two children. Up to 8 weeks of this may be taken before the expected date of delivery.
- For the third child onwards, Maternity Leave is **12 weeks**.
- Employees adopting a child below 3 months of age, or commissioning mothers through surrogacy, are entitled to **12 weeks** of leave from the date the child is handed over.
- In case of miscarriage or medical termination of pregnancy, employees are entitled to **6 weeks** of paid leave.
- After returning, employees may request a **work-from-home arrangement for up to 3 months**, subject to the nature of their role and manager approval.

Maternity Leave should be applied for on the HR portal at least **8 weeks before** the planned start date, along with a medical certificate stating the expected date of delivery.

8. Paternity Leave

- Male employees are entitled to **10 working days** of paid Paternity Leave on the birth or adoption of a child.
- Paternity Leave must be taken within **3 months** of the child's birth or adoption.
- It may be taken in up to **two blocks** (for example, 5 days + 5 days).
- Paternity Leave is available for the first two children only.

9. Bereavement Leave

In the unfortunate event of the death of an immediate family member, employees may take **5 working days** of paid Bereavement Leave.

- Immediate family includes spouse, children, parents, siblings, parents-in-law and grandparents.
- Bereavement Leave should be taken within **30 days** of the event.
- No documentation is required at the time of applying; HR may request supporting documents later if needed.

10. Marriage Leave

- Employees are entitled to **5 working days** of paid Marriage Leave for their own wedding.
- Marriage Leave can be availed **only once** during the employee's tenure at Nexora.

- It must be taken within **one month before or after** the wedding date and can be combined with Earned Leave.
- A copy of the wedding invitation or marriage certificate must be uploaded to the HR portal.

11. Compensatory Off (Comp Off)

When an employee is required by their manager to work on a weekend or public holiday, they become eligible for Compensatory Off.

- One full day of work (minimum 8 hours) on a weekend or holiday earns **one day of Comp Off**. Working between 4 and 8 hours earns **half a day**.
- Weekend work must be **pre-approved by the reporting manager** by email or on the HR portal; unapproved work does not earn Comp Off.
- Comp Off must be used within **60 days** of the date it was earned, after which it lapses.
- Comp Off is not encashable and cannot be carried into the next leave year.

12. Public and Floating Holidays

- Nexora observes **10 public holidays** each year. The holiday list is published by HR in December for the following year and varies slightly by office location.
- In addition, employees receive **2 Floating Holidays** per year, which can be used for any festival or personal occasion of their choice (for example Onam, Eid, Christmas, Holi or a birthday).
- Floating Holidays must be applied for at least **3 working days in advance** and lapse if unused by 31 December.

13. Leave Without Pay (LWP / Loss of Pay)

- When an employee has no applicable leave balance, absence will be treated as **Loss of Pay (LOP)**.
- LOP deduction per day = (Monthly Gross Salary / Number of calendar days in that month).
- Unauthorised absence for more than **3 consecutive working days** without informing the manager or HR will be treated as LOP and may lead to disciplinary action.
- Employees who need an extended break (beyond all leave balances) may apply for a **Sabbatical of up to 3 months** after completing 3 years of service. Sabbaticals are unpaid and require approval from the Department Head and HR Head.

14. How to Apply for Leave

All leave must be applied for on the **Nexora HR Portal (PeopleHub)**.

- 1 Log in to PeopleHub and go to **Leave > Apply Leave**.
- 2 Select the leave type, dates and whether it is a full day or half day.
- 3 Add a short reason and attach documents where required (for example, a medical certificate).
- 4 Submit the request. It goes to the reporting manager for approval.
- 5 The manager should approve or reject the request within **2 working days**. If no action is taken, the request is automatically escalated to the skip-level manager.

Employees should also update their calendar and set an out-of-office message on email and Teams before going on leave.

15. Approval Matrix

Leave Duration	Approver
Up to 3 days	Reporting Manager
4 to 15 days	Reporting Manager + Skip-level Manager
More than 15 days	Department Head + HR Business Partner
Maternity / Sabbatical	HR Head

16. Leave During Notice Period

- Employees serving their notice period may take Casual and Sick Leave as normal.
- Earned Leave **cannot be used to shorten the notice period**, unless specifically approved by the Department Head.
- Any leave taken during the notice period without approval will be treated as LOP and may extend the last working day.

17. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: I joined on 1 October. How much Casual Leave do I get this year?

A: Casual Leave is pro-rated at one day per month, so you will receive 3 days for October, November and December.

Q: Can I take Casual Leave and Earned Leave together for a week-long trip?

A: No. Casual Leave cannot be combined with Earned Leave. Please apply for the full period as Earned Leave.

Q: I was sick for 3 days. Do I need a medical certificate?

A: Yes. Any Sick Leave of more than 2 consecutive days requires a medical certificate uploaded within 3 working days of returning.

Q: I have 34 days of Earned Leave on 31 December. What happens?

A: You can carry forward a maximum of 30 days. The remaining 4 days will lapse unless you encashed some of them in the December payroll.

Q: I worked on a Sunday to support a production release. Will I get Comp Off?

A: Yes, if your manager approved the weekend work in advance. A full day of 8 hours or more earns one Comp Off, which must be used within 60 days.

Q: Does a public holiday in the middle of my Earned Leave count as leave?

A: No. Weekends and public holidays between Earned Leave days are not counted.

Q: Who approves a 10-day leave request?

A: Leave of 4 to 15 days needs approval from both your Reporting Manager and your Skip-level Manager.

Q: Is Sick Leave paid out when I resign?

A: No. Sick Leave is never encashable. Only Earned Leave (up to 30 days) is encashed in the full and final settlement.

18. Contact

For questions about this policy, contact your HR Business Partner or write to **hr-helpdesk@nexora.example**. Urgent leave-related issues can be raised through the PeopleHub helpdesk ticket option, which HR responds to within one working day.

This policy is reviewed every year by the Human Resources Department. Nexora reserves the right to amend this policy with 30 days' notice to employees.